

REPLACE

SUPPORTS TERTIARY WHY

FOR WHAT-HOW · HOW-WHAT

# The Vision Extraction Interview

A structured interview that pulls the vision out of the person who holds it, before execution begins. **Purpose gets borrowed from a primary source instead of generated from a drained one.**

## THE DRAIN

Executing against a vision you were never really given is a common fate for WHAT-HOW and HOW-WHAT profiles: the sponsor gestures at a direction, you fill the gaps with assumptions, and the gaps surface later as "that's not what I meant." Generating the missing vision yourself is exactly the work that drains you.

## WHAT THIS TOOL DOES

The interview replaces generation with extraction. Forty-five minutes of prepared questions, asked of the sponsor or WHY-primary who owns the intent, produces the vision in their words: what done looks like, what made it urgent, what would count as failure. You capture and structure, which is your energy, not theirs to waste.

## HOW TO USE IT

- 1 Book it before planning, not after.** Extraction after execution starts becomes negotiation. Get the vision while it is cheap.
- 2 Ask, then be quiet.** The pauses are where the real answers live. Resist filling them with options.
- 3 Read their answers back.** "Here is what I heard" in their own words. Correction now is nearly free.
- 4 Convert straight to the North Star page.** The interview is the raw material; Tool 22 is the artifact it becomes.

### The interview questions

- |                                                                                       |                                                                  |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>1</b> What does done look like, a year out?                                        | Push past deliverables to the changed situation.                 |
| <b>2</b> What made this urgent now?                                                   | The trigger reveals the real priority ordering.                  |
| <b>3</b> Delivered exactly as specified, what could still make you call it a failure? | This question earns its length. It surfaces the unstated intent. |
| <b>4</b> Who else has to believe in this?                                             | The map of people the vision must survive contact with.          |
| <b>5</b> What are you explicitly not asking for?                                      | Their exclusions, in their words, on the record.                 |

### WHAT IT WON'T DO

An interview cannot extract a vision that does not exist, and discovering that vacuum is one of its most valuable outcomes, escalate it, in writing, before building anything. The tool moves the purpose burden to where it belongs; it does not eliminate the need for the purpose to exist.

## IN THE KIT

Interview guide

Read-back script

North Star handoff template

## PAIRS WELL WITH

**Tool 22** North Star One-Pager · **Tool 21** Five-Question Purpose Brief · **Tool 42** The Handoff Contract